

the help files is a very big step in the successful configuration of your firewall. There is a learning curve when you use a firewall. Be prepared to spend some time learning how to configure and use it.

9. If you are running a third-party firewall such as Norton, McAfee or ZoneAlarm, be sure to turn off the Windows Firewall.
10. You can temporarily disable a firewall by right-clicking the icon in the tray. This is handy when you know a site is one you can trust but your firewall is blocking it. Be sure to re-enable the firewall as soon as possible.
11. Read firewall notices carefully when they pop up. There are two mistakes you can make, of course, if you don't: let a bad thing in or prevent good traffic.

Anti-Spyware

12. As with anti-virus software, you should check for updates regularly in the case of anti-spyware software as well.
13. Remember to do a scan every now and then, or schedule periodic bi-weekly scans if your program allows it. If you don't want to wait that long for the scan to complete, use a dedicated folder for your Internet downloads, then scan only that folder, the Windows folder, and the Registry. Another option is to use the 'Quick Scan' option if your program has it.

Anti-Spam

14. Be patient with anti-spam software. Don't give up on it if it doesn't seem to be working well enough! It *will* improve over time.
15. Even after it looks like your anti-spam software has 'learnt' all it needs to learn, you'll still need to check the 'Spam' folder periodically for good mail. No anti-spam solution is perfect (yet).
16. Don't supply your anti-spam program with too many rules, such as, for example, telling it that all mail from xyz bank should go into 'spam'. It's better if the software learns from such mails, and it will not learn if you give it the rule.